THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL FULL-YEAR PAPER SET 1

Full Syllabus (Chapters 1–8) | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–20 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 21–26 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 27–32 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 33–38 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 31–32 and Q. 36–38.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 20 × 1 = 20

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of the following best captures the irony in the story's reversal of roles? 1

(a) the serial ends **(b)** the learner bows to a young teacher
(c) the teacher is rich **(d)** the school is far

2. The author's decision to have Arenla leave the shed is best seen as: 1

(a) a joke
(b) a gesture of trust that completes the passing of the craft
(c) a mistake
(d) a punishment

3. The writer's real concern in 'Winds of Change' is best described as: 1

(a) fear of weather
(b) loss of cultural memory along with the craft
(c) dislike of electricity
(d) trade regulations

4. A reader says Mother is villainous. A better reading is that she is: 1

(a) careless of Ravi **(b)** jealous
(c) cruel **(d)** well-meaning but patronising

5. The writer's choice to end the interview with advice rather than achievement suggests that the aim is to: 1

(a) inform of dates **(b)** inspire action in readers
(c) boast **(d)** criticise

6. The central irony of 'Twin Melodies' is that Nabin: 1

(a) hates his daughter
(b) once defied tradition himself yet resists his daughter
(c) is a doctor
(d) loves fusion

7. The writer's main argument in 'Carrier of Words' is that: 1

(a) deserts are dangerous
(b) letters are old
(c) essential public services depend on ordinary people's dedication
(d) technology is wrong

8. The letter's most significant claim is that: 1

(a) dreams need no work
(b) dreams are luck
(c) dreams are earned through sustained commitment and help from others
(d) dreams are childish

9. 'Her eyes shone like lamps when the first line was read.' This is a: 1

(a) oxymoron **(b)** irony **(c)** simile **(d)** metaphor

10. The author criticises: 1

(a) a market that rewards show over skill **(b)** the narrator's friend
(c) boots **(d)** craftsmen

11. 'Canvas of Soil' can be read as a poem about: 1

(a) trade **(b)** politics
(c) creativity found in ordinary labour **(d)** machine design

12. What assumption does the mother make that the story challenges? 1

(a) that vitamins cure **(b)** that children are lazy
(c) that cities are unsafe **(d)** that old age equals incapacity

13. Which best explains why the poem uses a story in verse? 1

(a) a story makes values memorable **(b)** poems must tell stories
(c) stories are shorter **(d)** stories are facts

14. Which statement about Nabin's attitude is an inference? 1

(a) He fears fusion will dilute his life's work
(b) He is married to Leela
(c) He plays violin
(d) He is Shruti's father

15. In the poem, the idea 'words are seeds' implies that words: 1

(a) are small **(b)** are cheap
(c) are edible **(d)** grow into consequences

16. The illustrative metaphor of comfort as a trap implies that: 1

(a) comfort is evil **(b)** comfort is rare
(c) safety may cost us growth **(d)** comfort is cheap

17. A reader says, 'Patriotism needs hatred of others.' The poem: 1

(a) insults others **(b)** does not suggest this; it only praises
(c) is silent about land **(d)** supports this

18. Choose the correct reported speech: He said, 'Good boots last long.' 1

(a) He said good boots lasting long.
(b) He says good boots lasted long.
(c) He said that good boots last long.
(d) He said that good boots lasted long yesterday.

19. Choose the correct modal: If artisans had support, they ___ continued the craft. 1

(a) would have **(b)** can **(c)** will **(d)** may be

20. Choose the correct reported speech: Grandpa said, 'I have been fooling you all day.' 1

(a) Grandpa said that he has been fooling you all day.
(b) Grandpa told he had fooled.
(c) Grandpa said he was fool.
(d) Grandpa said that he had been fooling them all day.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 6 × 2 = 12

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

21. How does the author make a simple incident universally meaningful? 2

22. Why might Arenla's refusal be seen as both protective and limiting? 2

23. Evaluate the choice of the hand fan as a symbol of cultural change. 2

24. Analyse how dramatic irony works when the reader sees Grandpa's alertness. 2

25. Evaluate the claim that Dr Malik's story is more about attitude than about physical strength. 2

26. Examine the idea that Shruti's secrecy is both a flaw and a strength. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 6 × 3 = 18

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

27. Critically examine: 'The grandmother's courage is greater than the narrator's skill.' 3

28. Critically discuss 'Skills belong to the community' as a principle. 3

29. Critically comment on the claim that 'only what is useful survives'. 3

30. Critically examine: 'Grandpa wins the day without raising his voice.' 3

31. Critically examine the concept of 'inspiration' as used in the interview. 3

OR

Critically discuss the claim that 'tradition must be protected from innovation'. 3

32. Critically examine the ethical dimension of Khetaram's role. 3

OR

Critically evaluate the idea that 'success is the result of sacrifice'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 6 × 5 = 30

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

33. 'The story is a celebration of lifelong learning.' Discuss with textual support. 5

34. 'The Pot Maker is not only about pots but about the passing on of life itself.' Discuss. 5

35. 'The fan is a story told in wind.' Discuss the chapter in the light of this statement. 5

36. 'Vitamin-M' is a gentle satire of the way families treat the elderly. Discuss. 5

OR

'Dr Malik's story is not about overcoming disability but about redefining possibility.' Discuss. 5

37. 'Twin Melodies shows that conflict can be creative.' Discuss. 5

OR

'In honouring the postman, the writer honours the idea of public service.' Discuss. 5

38. 'The letter treats dreams as a contract between hope and effort.' Discuss. 5

OR

Critically appreciate 'Bharat Our Land'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 80 Marks**

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